

An AI **spec answer desk**, taken from pain to proven value.

Twelve stages. The formulas only. No invented numbers.



Samy Yusif

AI Products Section Head

Site keeps asking what the specification already answers.

Go and watch it happen. The same clause looked up by different people, in different weeks, answered from memory. Count the occurrences before you allow yourself to call it a problem.



Samy Yusif

AI Products Section Head

Size the pain before you fall in love with a solution.

$$\text{pain} = f \times t \times n \times \text{loaded rate}$$

Frequency, minutes per lookup, people involved, fully loaded rate. Then add the cost of a wrong answer times how often one slips through. If the total is small, stop here and say so out loud.



Samy Yusif

AI Products Section Head

Buy, build, or refuse. Refuse is a real answer.

Build only when the work is your differentiator and no vendor covers it. Everything else you buy or drop. Most AI failure begins as a solution walking around looking for a pain to attach to.



Samy Yusif

AI Products Section Head

Map the step you are changing, not the department.

Draw as-is and to-be side by side. AI replaces a step inside a process, never the process. Name the exact handoff that moves and name who owns the output after it moves.



Samy Yusif

AI Products Section Head

Count the reviewer. Most business cases pretend he is free.

$$ROI = (value - cost) / cost$$

Value is hours saved times rate, plus errors avoided times cost per error. Cost is build, tokens, review time and change management. Move work from doer to checker and you moved cost, not removed it.



Samy Yusif

AI Products Section Head

Retrieval first, model second, citation always.

Documents indexed with their clause numbers. A model allowed to answer only from what it retrieved. A clause reference on every answer. If it cannot point at a clause, it does not ship.



Samy Yusif

AI Products Section Head

Write down the risks you cannot mitigate, not only the ones you can.

Client document confidentiality. Contractual liability for a wrong answer given in writing. Vendor lock-in. A model that changes behaviour under you between versions. Each one needs a named owner.



Samy Yusif

AI Products Section Head

Permissions, logging and a spending ceiling before day one.

Who can see which project. Every question and answer logged. A hard monthly cost cap. Usage-based pricing with no ceiling is how a pilot turns into a board escalation nobody planned for.



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AI Products Section Head

Set the passing score before you see any results.

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accept if recall >= R and precision >= P
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Build a labelled set from real past questions whose answers are known. Decide which error hurts more, missing a clause or inventing one, and set the two thresholds accordingly. In writing, first.



Samy Yusif

AI Products Section Head

One project, one owner, one escalation path.

Release to a single project. Name the person who fixes bad answers. Route every complaint back into the test set. A pilot with no owner is a demo with a longer life expectancy.



Samy Yusif

AI Products Section Head

Logins are not adoption. Coming back is.

`adoption = repeat users / eligible users`

Measure who returns in week four without being reminded, and how deep they go. Seat counts and prompt counts are the most comfortable way to report activity as though it were value.



Samy Yusif

AI Products Section Head

Measure against the baseline you took before you started.

$$\text{realized} = (\text{base} - \text{actual}) \times \text{rate} - \text{run cost}$$

No baseline means you cannot claim the saving and cannot defend the budget. It is the same discipline as claiming schedule variance with no baseline programme, and it fails for the same reason.



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AI Products Section Head

Run stages one and two on your next idea before anything else.

Most ideas die honestly right there, and that is the cheapest place for them to die. The ones that survive have already earned the other ten stages.



Samy Yusif

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